

5.2 Benchmarking Tools

Benchmarking is the process of determining who or what is the best, who sets the standard, and what that standard is. Once we decide what to benchmark, and how to measure it, the object is to figure out how the winner got to be the best, and determine what we have to do to get there. For example, the Australian cricket team, for most fans, sets the benchmark. In the same manner, we pitch one computer system against set standards to assess performance.

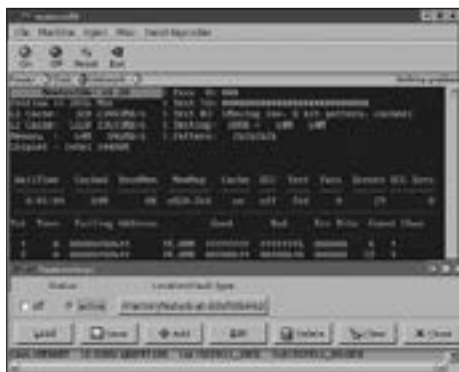
5.2.1 Memtest86 (www.memtest85.com)

Memtest86 is a RAM reliability tester. The underlying thesis is that a correctly-functioning computer should be able to store data in the RAM with 100 per cent accuracy. If it does not, then it will be unstable and prone to crashes.

Memtest86 is designed to stress-test the computer's RAM for errors. It is designed to run from a bootable floppy disk or CD-ROM, or from a suitable bootstrap loader, without an operating system being present. The tests are sufficiently harsh for it to find otherwise unrecognised problems on machines that appear to work normally.

Installation

For a Windows installation, you need to download either the Pre-Compiled Windows package, for building a bootable floppy disk, or an ISO (Zip version) to create a bootable CD. After the file download is complete, you decompress the file(s). To



Is your RAM all right? Memtest tells you All